Name:_____ Date:_____

Continuous and Discontinuous Variation







Continuous Variation (measures on a continuous scale)



Discontinuous Variation (falls into distinct, separate categories)

Look at each picture below. Decide whether it illustrates **continuous** or **discontinuous** variation, then tick the correct box.

1. Adult Height



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

2. ABO Blood Groups



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

3. Attached or Detached Earlobes



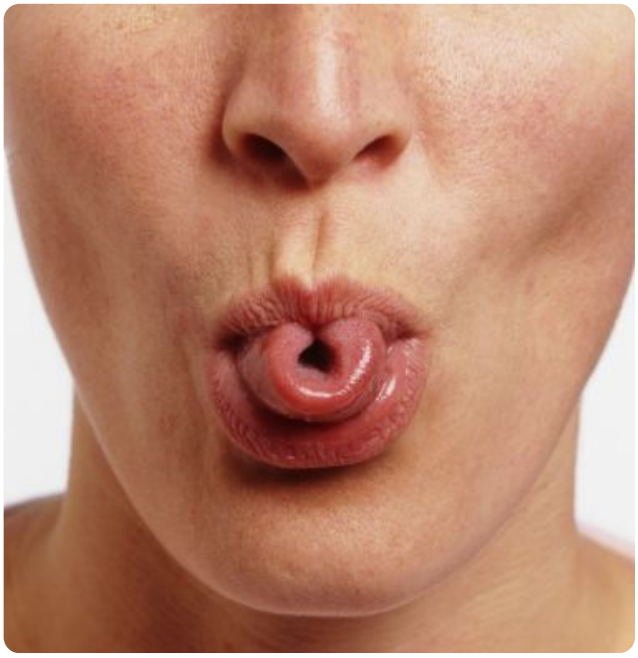
☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

4. Hand Span Measurement



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

5. Ability to Roll Tongue



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

6. Body Mass



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

7. Leaf Length



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

8. Seed Mass



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

9. Eye Colour Categories



☐ Continuous
☐ Discontinuous

Answers

1. ☑ Continuous ☐ Discontinuous *(Height can take any numerical value within a range).*

2. ☐ Continuous ☑ Discontinuous *(ABO blood groups fall into distinct categories: A, B, AB, or O).*

3. ☐ Continuous ☑ Discontinuous *(Earlobes are either attached or free/detached, with no intermediate values).*

4. ☑ Continuous ☐ Discontinuous *(Hand span is a continuous measurement in centimetres).*

5. ☐ Continuous ☑ Discontinuous *(A person can either roll their tongue or cannot roll it).*

6. ☑ Continuous ☐ Discontinuous *(Body mass can take any value along a continuous measurement scale).*

7. ☑ Continuous ☐ Discontinuous *(Leaf length can take a range of measured values).*

8. ☑ Continuous ☐ Discontinuous *(Seed mass can take a range of measured values).*

9. ☐ Continuous ☑ Discontinuous *(Eye colours can be grouped into categories, although natural colour varies in shades and category boundaries can be subjective).*